

choosing FI enables you to enjoy a flexible lifestyle. Let's look at tax strategies dealing with non-traditional approaches to work and retirement.

A common theme with people who discover FI is burnout from demanding careers that dominate their time. Even people in careers they enjoy sometimes burn out. But what if you worked fewer hours? People assume that if you work 25 percent or 50 percent less, your income goes down proportionally. This is not necessarily the case. Referring back to the example earlier in this chapter, the first dollars you earn are taxed favorably, but the last dollars you earn are taxed more heavily. This is particularly true of high earners. The blogger *Physician on FIRE* decided to cut his shifts by 40 percent to ease into retirement. If he worked any more than that, he would have lost 50 percent of subsequent earnings to taxes. Having the flexibility to work less allows you to earn money more efficiently. Hopefully, decreasing hours makes work less demanding and therefore more enjoyable.

I witnessed this in my own house. My wife decided she didn't want to return to full-time work after the birth of our daughter. At first, we questioned this decision because we assumed we would have to work longer to save enough to retire. When we ran the numbers, we